

Instructor Responsibilities & Requirements Nurse Aide Training Program (CNA)

Building Skills. Changing Lives. Advancing Healthcare.

Policy Reference: GAHCTC Instructor Handbook • Applies to: Program Coordinator, Primary Instructors, and Supplemental Instructors • Review cycle: Annual

1 | PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This document establishes the qualifications, approval process, responsibilities, and conduct standards for all personnel who teach in the GA Healthcare Training & Consulting (GAHCTC) Nurse Aide Training Program (NATP). It applies to the Program Coordinator, all primary classroom, skills lab, and clinical instructors, and all supplemental or guest instructors, whether engaged as employees or as independent contractors.

Nurse aide training in Georgia is a regulated activity. Instructors are not simply teaching a course — they are executing a state-approved curriculum on behalf of a program whose approval depends on documented compliance. Every requirement in this document exists because a regulator, a clinical partner, or a student's certification eligibility depends on it.

Program approval status. The GAHCTC Nurse Aide Training Program is pending approval by the Georgia Department of Community Health (DCH) through its state contractor, Alliant Health Solutions. **No nurse aide class may begin, and no instructor may teach, until written program approval and individual faculty approval have been issued.**

2 | REGULATORY FRAMEWORK

- **42 CFR Part 483, Subpart D, §§ 483.150–483.158** — federal nurse aide training and competency evaluation requirements, including the Federal Core Curriculum.
- **Georgia Nurse Aide Training Program Manual** — issued by DCH and administered by Alliant Health Solutions; published at mmis.georgia.gov and updated quarterly.
- **Georgia Board of Nursing** — licensure standing for all RN and LPN faculty.
- **Credentia** — administers the NNAAP written and skills competency examinations under contract with Georgia DCH; results are reported to the Georgia Nurse Aide Registry maintained by Alliant Health Solutions.

Instructors are responsible for reviewing the current Nurse Aide Training Program Manual quarterly. GAHCTC maintains the most recent copy on file in the program office.

3 | MINIMUM QUALIFICATIONS

Role	Minimum Qualifications
Program Coordinator	Registered Nurse with a current, active Georgia license in good standing with the Georgia Board of Nursing (license may not carry a status of probation, suspended, expired, lapsed, inactive, pending, renewal pending, revoked, or surrendered). • Two (2) years of nursing experience as an RN • At least one (1) of those years as an RN in a long-term care facility (nursing home) • Train-the-Trainer Workshop certificate from Alliant Health Solutions • Current résumé on file
Primary Instructor (classroom, lab, and/or clinical)	Registered Nurse or Licensed Practical Nurse with a current, active Georgia license in good standing with the Georgia Board of Nursing (same disqualifying status codes as above). • Minimum one (1) year of nursing experience • Train-the-Trainer Workshop certificate from Alliant Health Solutions • Current résumé on file
Supplemental / Expert Instructor (guest speakers)	Healthcare or subject-matter professional assisting with a defined portion of instruction — for example, a CPR instructor, an Alzheimer's/dementia speaker, or an Ombudsman representative. • Minimum one (1) year of experience in their field • Name, job title, and work experience documented in the program file and on the program application

Additional GAHCTC Requirements (All Instructional Personnel)

- Current American Heart Association BLS Provider certification.
- Satisfactory criminal background check and any screening required by the assigned clinical facility.
- Current negative TB screening (PPD or QuantiFERON) and any immunization records required by the clinical site.
- Professional liability coverage as specified in the employment or independent contractor agreement.
- Completed GAHCTC onboarding packet, signed Instructor Handbook acknowledgment, and documented Instructor Orientation.
- Working familiarity with the program textbook — *Hartman's Nursing Assistant Care: The Basics*, 6th edition — and with TalentLMS for the blended-learning track.

4 | FACULTY APPROVAL PROCESS

Instructors must be individually approved by the state contractor before teaching. Approval is not transferable between programs.

	Requirement
Step 1	The Program Coordinator submits a written letter to Alliant Health Solutions requesting approval of the RN or LPN to serve as an instructor in the classroom and/or clinical portion of the program.

	Requirement
Step 2	The request is accompanied by a copy of the current Georgia nursing license, an updated résumé, and a copy of the Train-the-Trainer Workshop certificate.
Step 3	GAHCTC completes and files the Instructor Orientation record — orientation to the classroom, lab, and equipment placement; orientation to lesson plans and skills rubrics; instructor observation of the proctor teaching and performing skills check-offs; proctor observation of the instructor's teaching and skills check-off methodology; and review of state guidelines. Each item is initialed and dated by both proctor and instructor, with the time spent recorded.
Step 4	For a first-time instructor without nursing home experience, the Program Coordinator attends the first clinical rotation with the instructor.
Step 5	The signed orientation record is retained in the program file at all times for audit purposes. Instruction begins only after approval is confirmed.

Change notification. Any change to program faculty, curriculum, schedule, location, or any other element of the approved application must be submitted to Alliant Health Solutions in writing within **ten (10) business days**, and may not be implemented until approval is granted.

5 | INSTRUCTIONAL RESPONSIBILITIES

Classroom

- Deliver the approved lesson plan for each scheduled day as written, covering all Federal and State Core Curriculum content with the assigned textbook page references.
- Ensure the first six subject areas — communication and interpersonal skills including stress management and chain of command; infection control; safety, emergency, FBAO and body mechanics; promoting residents' independence; respecting residents' rights; and legal/ethical behavior and scope of practice — are completed before any student has direct contact with a resident.
- Administer module tests and the comprehensive final examination on the scheduled days; apply the 80% minimum passing score and provide documented remediation before the student advances.
- Monitor and support students in the self-paced TalentLMS theory portion for blended-learning cohorts.

Skills Laboratory

- Demonstrate each required skill using the textbook rubric or the program-created rubric, then observe and evaluate student return demonstration.
- Check off every mandatory skill on the Core Curriculum Required Skills Checklist at **100% proficiency**. Skills may be added to the checklist but none may be deleted.
- Teach all mandatory skills the textbook way and complete check-off before any state competency skills material from the Georgia Candidate Handbook is used.
- Ensure lab equipment and supplies are clean, organized, adequately stocked, and in good working condition before and after every session; report shortages or malfunctions immediately.

- Maintain a student-to-instructor ratio in the lab that permits direct observation of every return demonstration.

Clinical Rotation

- Provide direct, on-site supervision of students throughout the clinical rotation in the long-term care facility. Students are never left unsupervised with residents.
- Arrive ahead of the 7:00 a.m. start for preconference; students are expected on site by 6:45 a.m.
- Verify before the first clinical day that each student has completed background clearance, TB documentation, and student professional liability coverage.
- Complete the facility sign-in/sign-out log for both students and instructor, recording arrival and departure times, and obtain facility employee verification.
- Permit students to perform only those skills they have been taught and checked off, and only within the Georgia nurse aide scope of practice.
- Enforce clinical site conduct standards: no cell phones on the unit, no photographs of residents, full HIPAA compliance, active engagement throughout the shift, and adherence to all facility rules.
- Report and document any incident, injury, or resident concern to the Program Coordinator and the facility charge nurse the same day.

6 | DOCUMENTATION AND RECORDKEEPING

Documentation is a regulatory obligation, not administrative overhead. Instructors complete the following the same day the activity occurs:

- Daily attendance, including tardiness, absence, and make-up hours applied under the program attendance policy.
- Skills performance checklists, dated and signed at the point of successful return demonstration.
- Test scores, remediation records, and student evaluation forms with progress notes.
- Clinical sign-in/sign-out logs and clinical performance evaluations.
- Incident, injury, and behavioral documentation.

Students must complete all approved program hours before a Certificate of Completion is issued. The certificate must contain every element required by the state form, must be notarized, and **may not be notarized by the instructor or Program Coordinator who taught the student**. The approved faculty member's name appears at the bottom of the certificate. GAHCTC retains student records for three (3) years.

7 | PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT AND COMPLIANCE

- Maintain licensure in good standing and notify the Program Coordinator immediately of any change in license status, disciplinary action, or lapse in required certification.
- Represent GAHCTC professionally at every clinical and community site; to the facility, the instructor is the organization.

- Report at once any suspected abuse, neglect, exploitation, or misappropriation of resident property, consistent with mandatory reporting obligations.
- Protect resident and student confidentiality at all times.
- Teach the approved curriculum without substitution, abbreviation, or unapproved modification. Curriculum concerns are raised with the Program Coordinator, not resolved independently.
- Never falsify attendance, hours, skills check-offs, test scores, or clinical documentation.
- Refer students to the Program Coordinator for matters outside the instructional role — grievances, financial questions, accommodation requests, and disciplinary action.
- Cooperate fully with announced and unannounced on-site visits by Alliant Health Solutions.

8 | MAINTAINING APPROVAL AND GROUNDS FOR REMOVAL

Continued teaching eligibility depends on maintaining an active Georgia license in good standing, current BLS certification, current TB and background documentation, quarterly review of the Nurse Aide Training Program Manual, and satisfactory performance on classroom, lab, and clinical observations conducted by the Program Coordinator.

An instructor may be removed from assignment, and the state contractor notified, for any of the following: lapse or adverse action on licensure; falsification of program records; failure to provide required supervision during clinical; teaching outside the approved curriculum; breach of confidentiality; conduct resulting in removal by a clinical facility; or repeated failure to complete required documentation.

Instructor Acknowledgment

I have read and understand the responsibilities and requirements set out above. I attest that I meet the stated qualifications for the role I have been assigned, that my Georgia nursing license is active and in good standing, and that I will notify the Program Coordinator immediately of any change in that status. I agree to teach the approved curriculum, supervise students as described, and complete all required documentation.

Instructor Name (print): _____ GA License #: _____

Role assigned: ____ Program Coordinator ____ Primary Instructor ____ Supplemental Instructor

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Program Coordinator: _____ Date: _____